

Ethan Zaruba-Walker

ethan@staffroomai.com | (512) 694-4844 | LinkedIn

September 16, 2026

Dear Fulcrum hiring team,

I am writing about the Forward Deployed AI Engineer role in San Francisco. For three years I have been the only technical person on my own engagements: I run discovery with a customer's operating team, build the automation, and stay until they can run it without me. I live in Emeryville, so five days in the office is a short commute.

Account managers stuck keying data and chasing documents instead of talking to clients is the class of operational drag I already remove. You just raised a Series A, and the product sits in Outlook and the AMS brokers already use, which is where adoption is won. Insurance brokerage operations are new to me. I learn a domain by mapping the current workflow with the people who run it, then automating the manual step that burns the hours.

How that maps to what you need:

- **Customer implementation:** I automated an IT MSP's pre-sales risk assessments, cut processing time 98%, then trained their team to keep extending the workflow. The same discovery-to-handover loop is how I would take a first workflow live and fold the reusable pieces back into the core product.
- **Python daily, TypeScript in production:** public OAuth app and Notion API integrations in TypeScript and Python, with CI that tests live API connectivity. Claude Code is my daily driver for iterating with customers.
- **Docs and mixed rooms:** at IBM Customer Support I wrote the release notes and product documentation that walked stakeholders through each change, after Design Thinking sessions that surfaced the actual need.
- **Owner, not renter:** I source, scope, price, and deliver my own book. Not a regional quota. The entire number for my own business.

Two gaps, named plainly. TypeScript is in production on those integrations, not the language I reach for first; Python is. Insurance brokerage is a new domain. Neither is a reason to slow down a customer engagement. Both are things I will be explicit about while I ramp.

Thank you for your time and consideration. I would welcome the chance to talk about which customizations you are folding back into the core product first.

Sincerely,

Ethan Zaruba-Walker